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10

Science Books

every geek must read

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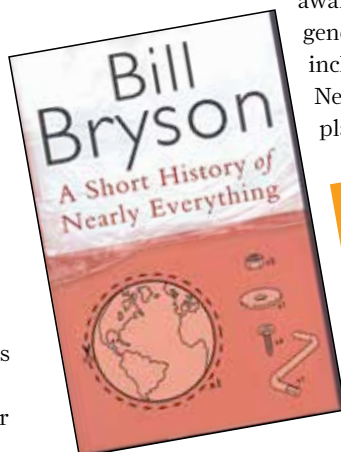
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Books in the popular science genre have the unique ability to awe, thrill and inform at the same time. In today's application driven world, Science books can give us the highly underrated pleasure of discovery along with a slice of history. In this article, we list down science books everyone should read. The books on the list have a timeless quality about them – they're lucidly written and brilliantly researched making them not only good popular science books, but great reads in general.

1 A Short History to Nearly Everything by Bill Bryson

If you go through any list of popular science books, odds are that Bryson's wonderfully written book will be at the top of the list. Bill Bryson is known for his travel writing in which he displays a brand of humour peppered with anecdotes. Because Bryson isn't trained as a scientist, his approach is fresh making this book read less like a drab description



of a scientific concept and more like the account of a curious kid amazed by the grandeur of science. The book touches upon areas of science ranging from microbiology to cosmology and never once loses grip of its motive – to generate genuine interest in science. Bryson gives us accounts of famous personalities in science and talks about their oddities. He attempts to show the range of sizes in science to scale by using comparisons. Garnering multiple awards and inspiring generations of kids (ourselves included) 'A Short History to Nearly Everything' deserves a place on every bookshelf.

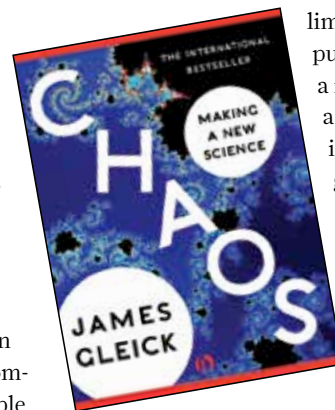
2 Chaos by James Gleick

Chaos theory gained acceptance fairly late compared to other heavy-weight theories such as Quantum Mechanics and Relativity, but grew

rapidly in popularity. A term often used to describe the theory is 'Butterfly Effect', which underlines that a butterfly

flapping its wings can cause a hurricane on the opposite side of the Earth.

This theory was brought into limelight in 1987 when Gleick published 'Chaos'. Gleick is a masterful science writer and historian, and this book is a brilliant example of his genius. He begins by giving us an account of time when chaos theory was one of those neglected theories, shunned by the bigwigs of science. The book is a story of the bravado and triumph of those



unheralded scientists who dedicated their careers to unravelling the mysteries surrounding a theory that today is critical in predicting weather and understanding patterns in various physical systems. The book made "Butterfly Effect" a household term and is largely responsible for introducing the concepts of chaos theory and fractal geometry to a broad audience. Chaos theory is now a staple in pop culture and even played a large role in Michael Crichton's bestselling book, 'Jurassic Park'.

3 The Perfect Theory by Pedro Ferreira

Cosmologist Pedro Ferreira's book is the definitive biography of Albert